**Purpose & Scope**

This procedure serves as a clear guide for employees in Internal Audit (IA), Human Resources (HR), Occupational Health and Safety (OHS), Food Safety and Quality Assurance (FSQA), Animal Care (AC), and Legal and Information Services (IS) employees collectively referred to as the "Departments" who are tasked with investigating, evaluating, and resolving Reports concerning **Significant** or **Minor** breaches of Maple Leaf Foods Inc. ("the Company") policies, Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs), or best practices (refer to: Corporate Policies - Home). It describes the expected practices for conducting **internal investigations** and should be followed; however, deviations may be required in specific circumstances:

- If a more **specific Company policy, law, or regulatory requirement applies** for example:
  - Those related to criminal, privacy, securities, competition and/or environmental law or incidents including or Recalls, Cyber-breach, or Privacy), then the actions must comply with that policy or legal requirement.
  - Employees must inform themselves or consult with Legal regarding application law and/or regulations.
  - In the event of an inconsistency between applicable law and/or regulations and this SOP, the employee should comply with the applicable law and/or regulations and confer with Legal as appropriate.
- If the situation involves **external third parties** such as customers, commercial partners, or regulatory authorities, especially in cases where potential legal disputes may arise, the IA and Legal teams must be notified and will direct the next steps.
- If **IA or Legal have explicitly approved an alternative process**, that approved process may be followed instead of this procedure.

In summary, while this document provides general guidance, employees must always defer to any explicit instructions from IA, Legal, or requirements set by more specific policies or applicable laws and regulations.

**Definitions**

- "Company" means Maple Leaf Foods Inc.
- "Department" means employees within the IA, HR, OHS, FSQA, AC, Legal and IS departments, individually.
- "Incident Reporter" means a person alleging that a breach of Company policy, SOP, or best practice has occurred.
- "Investigator" means a person appointed to investigate a Report.
- "Report" means a complaint or incident, written or oral, that alleges that a breach of Company policy, SOP, or best practice has occurred.
- "Respondent" means a person who is alleged to have breached a Company policy, SOP, or best practice.

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**Guiding Principles**

The Company is committed to a fair, respectful, and thorough approach to Report resolution. The following principles guide the Company's approach to responding to all Reports:

- All Reports are taken seriously.
- Investigations are initiated promptly.
- Processes are thorough and clearly communicated.
- Retaliation against Incident Reporters, who submit Reports in good faith, is strictly prohibited.
- Confidentiality is maintained throughout.
- Investigations are impartial and unbiased.

**Intake and Acknowledgement**

All Reports, whether from inside or outside of the organization, should be directed through the approved channels which include:

- Directly to supervisors, managers, HR, or executives, through phone calls, emails, or in-person discussions.
- EthicsLine via web or phone call.

Once a Report is received, confirmation of receipt should be sent to the Incident Reporter within one to three business days, depending on the seriousness and sensitivity of the Report.

Upon Intake, the following should be documented regarding the formal Report being received:

- Date of Report receipt.
- Names and roles of any individual mentioned in the Report.
- Primary issue/type of Report (Refer to ***Appendix I – Types of Reports***).
- Whether the Incident Reporter was anonymous or not.
- Detailed description of the allegations or concerns.
- Source of Report (i.e. EthicsLine, direct report).
- Any supporting documents or evidence provided at the time of submission, if applicable.

**Triaging and Assigning an Investigator**

For all incoming Reports, each Department leader (or their designate) will select an individual to review and assign an Investigator who is not named in the complaint and who has the relevant expertise for the specific allegation, to conduct the investigation. For any incoming Report which is Significant, the Department Leader (or their designate) should confer with IA and Legal to approve chosen Investigator and next steps. To further enhance the effectiveness and consistency of investigations, departments are encouraged to regularly rely on a select group of individuals as investigators. By doing so, these individuals can build specialized expertise in handling various types of cases. This approach not only ensures a higher standard of investigative quality but also streamlines the process and fosters continuous improvement through accumulated experience. Department leaders should consider

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maintaining a roster of trained investigators who are routinely assigned to cases, provided they are not named in the complaint and have the relevant expertise for the specific allegation. If Department leaders are unsure about the correct triage process or the most suitable Investigator to assign, they should consult with Internal Audit (Director or Vice President (VP)) for guidance.

The following highlights the leader(s) for each Department:

- **IA** – VP, IA or Director, IA
- **HR** – VP, HR - Labour Relations & Operations
- **OHS** – Director, OHS
- **FSQA** – VP, FSQA
- **AC** – VP, AC & FSQA-Poultry
- **IS** – VP IS
- **Legal –** SVP General Counsel & Corporate Secretary

The following provides high-level definitions of the three levels of investigations that incoming Reports should be classified as:

- **Level 1: Significant Investigation –** A formal inquiry into Reports of potential violations of law, Company policy, or SOPs that may lead to serious consequences for individuals or the Company. This includes risks to employee well-being, consumer safety, regulatory compliance, operational integrity, or brand reputation, and involves management or senior leadership. This includes risks to employee well-being, consumer safety, regulatory compliance, operational integrity, or brand reputation, and/or involves management or senior leadership.
- **Level 2: Minor Investigation –** An inquiry into Reports of potential breaches of Company policy, SOPs, or best practices that pose limited legal, financial, or reputational risk. If substantiated, these may result in moderate consequences for individuals or the Company.
- **Level 3: No Formal Investigation –** A classification for low-risk and isolated Reports with no expected impact on individuals, Company operations, consumer safety, or regulatory compliance. These do not warrant formal review or disciplinary action.

The following circumstances will also likely prompt the need for an investigation:

- Repeat offences or patterns of behaviour (i.e. the same, or similar, Reports alleged against the same employee more than two times).
- Reports that allege a previous Report was not resolved, or the investigation carried out was unsatisfactory.

Refer to ***Appendix II – Investigations Classification by Department*** for further details.

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**Investigation Procedures**

## 1. Significant and Minor Investigations

Investigations at the Company are classified as either **Significant** or **Minor**, depending on the nature, scope, and potential impact of the alleged breach of policy, SOP, or best practice. The primary difference between these two categories is the level of inquiry and procedural rigor applied; **Significant** investigations involve comprehensive document reviews, multiple interviews for corroboration, and close consultation with IA or Legal teams as needed, along with detailed reporting and notification to senior leadership. For Significant Investigations, it is required to notify Legal and IA teams at the outset to address any potential or perceived conflicts of interest, secure legal interpretation of relevant laws, implement litigation holds or establish privilege when appropriate. At the conclusion of any **Significant** investigation, IA and Legal must be provided with a copy of the investigation report to ensure both departments have a holistic view of all investigations, support accurate reporting to auditors, the board, and management and offer an opportunity to evaluate the effectiveness of the investigative process.

**Minor** investigations involve fewer interviews, limited document collection, and are generally resolved within departmental protocols without escalating to IA or Legal unless new facts emerge. The classification process specifically considers the seriousness and severity of the allegation, ensuring that more complex or sensitive Reports receive a proportionately thorough investigative approach.

The following outlines the procedures to be followed when conducting a **Significant** or **Minor** investigation.

### 1.1 Investigation Planning by Assigned Investigator

#### 1.1.1 Scope Definition

Clearly define the specific Report that will be the focus of the investigation. Outline the key allegations that need to be addressed. Identify a list of individuals or materials needed to provide relevant information or context, such as subject matter experts, witnesses, relevant documents and video or audio recordings.

#### 1.1.2 Review of Company Policies

Identify and understand the behavioral requirements outlined in Company policies, SOPs, best practices, applicable laws and/or regulations and any available third-party guidance relevant to the investigation.

#### 1.1.3 Timeline

Develop a clear and realistic timeline for conducting and completing the investigation, considering the complexity of the Report, the availability of key witnesses, and the seriousness or sensitivity of the allegations. Ensure that the schedule allows for a thorough and fair process while maintaining a sense of urgency and accountability. Where timelines extend beyond what is reasonable (generally, two to three weeks) for EthicsLine Reports and **Significant** investigations,

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Investigators need to inform and provide reasoning to Internal Audit (Director or VP) of any unanticipated delays.

#### 1.1.4 Notification

Consider the need to notify relevant parties about the investigative procedures (e.g., executive leaders, identified witnesses, and management who may be required to support) as appropriate, maintaining confidentiality and always protecting the integrity of the investigation. Only those who have a need to know the information should be informed. If Investigators are uncertain about whom to notify, they should consult with Internal Audit (Director or VP) for guidance to ensure proper protocol is followed

### 1.2 Evidence Collection by Assigned Investigator

#### 1.2.1 Document Review

Securely and confidentially gather all pertinent documentation related to the investigation, such as emails, reports, video or audio recordings, security logs, and other relevant records. When obtaining materials from direct reports or supervisors of the Respondent, ensure that all data is obtained in a manner that complies with privacy and data protection protocols. It is essential that the collection process does not unnecessarily disclose the nature or details of the Report, in order to preserve confidentiality and protect the integrity of the investigation.

#### 1.2.2 Interviews

Conduct interviews with all relevant parties, including the Incident Reporter (if not anonymous), the Respondent, and any key witnesses.

- **Prepare an Interview Guide**: Consider results from 1.1.2 as well as the facts of the Report and develop a list of open-ended, neutral, and non-judgmental questions aimed at uncovering the facts, focusing on the who, what, where, when, why and how of the Report.
- **Documentation:** Take detailed notes during the interview to ensure accuracy and completeness in capturing details. In circumstances where the interview is going to be recorded, ensure to obtain the interviewee and union representative's consent, if applicable before proceeding.
- **Interview Team:** It is recommended to have two Investigators present, one to lead the discussion and the other to take notes, observe and corroborate interview details. If the Incident Reporter, Respondent or a witness request that their legal counsel be present, advise Legal.
- **Union Representation:** If the Incident Reporter or Respondent is a unionized employee, ensure that, if a union representative is required to be present in the interview, they are in attendance before proceeding with the interview.
- **Confidentiality:** Limit discussion of the Report and investigation to individuals directly involved in the process. Begin each interview by emphasizing the importance of confidentiality and request that the interviewee not share details of the interview or its occurrence.

DRAFT

- **Non-Retaliation Reminder:** Reassure the interviewee that the Company has a strict non-retaliation policy, meaning that participation in the interview and the honest disclosure of information will not result in any form of penalization.
- **Protecting Identities:** Whenever possible, avoid disclosing the identities of other individuals involved in the Report to maintain privacy and reduce potential bias or retaliation.
- **Interim Measures:** If there are concerns that the Respondent may engage in inappropriate actions following the interview, Investigators should promptly convene a meeting with HR to discuss these concerns. After the interview, HR may decide to place the Respondent on leave pending the results of the investigation. Investigators must immediately consult HR if they believe that anyone's safety or any Company assets may be at risk.

#### 1.2.3 Analysis

Analyze any collected evidence that contravenes applicable Company policies, SOPs and recognized best practices. Identify and document any inconsistencies, violations, or gaps. Where appropriate, consult with Internal Audit (Director or VP) to assess the significance of the findings and determine whether implications exist that may require the involvement of the Company's Legal team.

#### 1.2.4 Decision Making

After reviewing all relevant evidence derived from interviews or other investigative procedures, the Investigator will defer with the Department Leader and HR to finalize the decision regarding any disciplinary actions. Once a final decision has been reached, HR is responsible for communicating the outcome to all parties involved in the investigation.

### 1.3 Reporting

Prepare a comprehensive investigation report that includes, at a minimum, the following:

- **Introduction / Background:** A summary of the scope of the investigation.
- **Allegation:** A clear description of the Report received.
- **Key Findings:** A factual summary of evidence collected, including any identified breaches or violations of Company policy, SOP, or best practice.
- **Conclusion:** A conclusion, including whether the Report was substantiated or not.
- **Actions Taken:** A summary of corrective or disciplinary actions implemented because of the investigation.
- **Preventative Measures (if applicable):** A summary of how the relevant Department will take actions to prevent the situation from happening again.

Refer to ***Appendix III – Significant Investigation Report Template*** and ***Appendix IV – Minor Investigation Report Template*** for report templates, for both **Significant** investigations and **Minor** investigations, and an example of details required when preparing a report for each type. If the Investigator's Department provides templates that cover, at a minimum, the criteria above, Investigators may use the Department Required Template* rather than preparing a formal report. The use of any alternative template beyond those noted below must be approved by IA.

DRAFT

*Department Required Template

- HR to update and maintain their departmental Discipline Investigation Report (DIR) and Investigation Tracker.
- OHS to update and maintain departmental Incident Investigation Report and Investigation Tracker.
- FSQA to complete departmental QN via SAP and Form B.
- AC to complete departmental Investigation Summary Form for unionized sites and Golden Rules Infraction Form for non-unionized sites.

**1.4 Communication by Assigned Investigator**

For all EthicsLine Reports and **Significant** investigations, share the final report with the Department lead as well as Internal Audit (Director or VP). The conclusion and actions taken should be communicated to the Department Leader, as well, to the Complainant and Respondent as appropriate.

**1.5 IA Review and Communication**

IA will review investigation reports and, when required, communicate a summary of findings and outcomes to relevant committees such as the Ethics, Audit, or HR and Compensation Committees.

**1.6 Closure and Archiving by IA or Relevant Department (e.g., Assigned Investigator)**

**1.6.1 Report Management – Opening and Closure**

If the Report comes through EthicsLine:

- IA is responsible for formally recording the Report, processing all updates and eventually closing the Report in both NAVEX and their EthicsLine Reporting Weekly Update file.

If a Report is made directly to a supervisor, manager, HR, or executive by phone, email, or in person:

- IA should be informed of any **Significant** investigations, and a summary should be added to the EthicsLine Reporting Weekly Update by Internal Audit (Director or VP).
- When a Report is closed, this should be noted in the Department's documentation and the status updated in the respective Department's Investigation Tracker.
- If the Report results in a **Significant** investigation, IA will also record and close the Report in both NAVEX and the EthicsLine Reporting Weekly Update file.

**1.6.2 Secure Archiving**

Ensure all investigation records are stored securely in accordance with the Records and Information Management Policy, for a minimum of eight years, unless otherwise specified by legal requirements.

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## 2. No Formal Investigation

Not all Reports received within the organization will result in a **Significant** or **Minor** investigation. In some cases, the nature of the concern may be more appropriately addressed through informal resolution methods or proactive support measures.

It is essential that all Reports are handled with care, consistency, and in accordance with this procedure. The following outlines the steps to be taken when addressing Reports that do not require a formal investigation. These procedures ensure that concerns are acknowledged, appropriate actions are taken, and proper documentation is maintained.

### 2.1 Informal Discussions

Meet with the Incident Reporter (if not anonymous) to understand their allegation(s). Facilitate a conversation or mediation between parties, if appropriate. Conduct any discussion in a confidential and private meeting room.

- If the Incident Reporter or Respondent is a unionized employee, ensure that if required, a union representative is present before proceeding with any discussions.

### 2.2 Coaching or Training

Provide targeted coaching to the Respondent involved to address identified behavioural or communication concerns. Where appropriate, recommend or require participation in training programs, such as Respect in the Workplace or other relevant training to support improvement and reinforce expectations.

### 2.3 Documentation

Complete the Department Required Template* and update the Department Investigation Tracker. At a minimum, documentation should include:

- Date of Report.
- Details of Report.
- Names of Respondents and other employees involved in the Report.
- Details of interview(s) held (date, name(s) of interviewee(s), names of attendee(s) summary of discussions).
- Outcomes of the Report, such as what action was taken.

*Department Required Template

- HR to update and maintain their departmental DIR and Investigation Tracker.
- OHS to update and maintain departmental Incident Investigation Report and Investigation Tracker.
- FSQA to complete departmental QN via SAP and Form B (if applicable).
- AC to complete departmental Investigation Summary form for unionized sites and Golden Rules Infraction form for non-unionized sites.

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### 2.4 Closure and Archiving by IA or Relevant Department (e.g., Assigned Investigator)

#### 2.4.1 Report Management – Closure

If the Report comes through EthicsLine:

- IA must close the case in NAVEX and update the EthicsLine Reporting Weekly Update file to show that no **Significant** or **Minor** investigation occurred, as the issue was handled locally.

If the Report is made directly to a supervisor, manager, HR, or executive by phone, email, or in person:

- Closure must be noted in the respective Departments' documentation and status updated within their Department's Investigation Tracker.

#### 2.4.2 Secure Archiving

Ensure all investigation records are stored securely in accordance with the Records and Information Management Policy, for a minimum of eight years, unless otherwise specified by legal requirements.

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**Appendix I – Types of Reports**

See below for a list of Report types and a definition of each, which should be referenced when documenting details of Report upon intake. Note that this is not an exhaustive list.

| Incident Report Type | Definition |
|---|---|
| Accounting/Audit Irregularities | Acts related to the misstatement and/or destruction of Company audit work papers or accounting documents. Acts that fraudulently influence any public or certified accountant who is either preparing financial statements or conducting an audit for the Company. This is usually performed at the corporate level. It does not include Wage/Hour Issues nor cash register issues.<br><br>Examples: A person destroys accounting documents to keep auditors from discovering poor accounting practices. A person knowingly enters false information into the Company's financial records. |
| Animal Welfare | Any act that represents deliberate animal abuse, harm, neglect or mishandling. The failure to provide the basic necessities of food, water and adequate ventilation. |
| Conflicts of Interest | An employee owes a duty to the employer to act in the interest of the employer (and no other) when carrying out the duties of an employer. A Conflict of Interest exists when the employee has some personal kinship, friendship or financial interest in the transaction that may divide the employee's interests and put their duty to their employer in jeopardy. Common actions include but are not limited to: sending a customer to a business owned by the employee or one in which the employee has some kind of interest; working for a competitor in any manner while working the Company; accepting gifts or money from a supplier in order to gain additional business; using Company goods and services to support their own business. |
| Customer Relations | The real or perceived display of lack of customer service or courtesy exhibited by employees of the Company either by actions, lack of action, or something which was said by an employee or a combination of both. |
| Discrimination | Any act or omission which includes discrimination-based race, colour, religion, age, nationality, gender, sexual orientation, disability, or any other protected category. |
| Employee Relations | Any act or omission, which is perceived to be detrimental to the physical or mental well-being of an employee, including but not limited to, mistreatment and inappropriate behaviour. Issues related to the 'Retaliation Against Whistleblowers' should be classified as such. For more information regarding retaliation issues, see the 'Retaliation Against Whistleblowers' definition. |

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| Incident Report Type | Definition |
|---|---|
| Falsification of Company Records | Any act or omission, which alters any company record from its genuine condition to a false condition. If the document is considered an accounting document, classify the incident as 'Accounting/Audit Irregularities'. If the falsification resulted in some form of gain for the perpetrator or benefactor, classify as 'Fraud'. |
| Fraud | Deliberate attempts to deceive to receive gain, such as a fraudulent refund, transaction, or credit card. Issues related to the misstatement and/or destruction of Company audit workpapers or accounting documents should be classified as 'Accounting/Audit Irregularities'. For more information, see 'Accounting/Audit Irregularities' definition. |
| Insider Trading | The buying or selling of stock is based on insider information that is not available to the general public. An insider is defined as someone who has access to or possession of important information about a company that affects its stock price, or which might influence investors' decisions. This Incident Report type includes buying or selling the Company's stock based on non-public information as well as passing this information on to someone else who then buys or sells stock. |
| Kickbacks | The solicitation or acceptance of cash, gifts or favours to perform, a function which the employee is required by the job description to perform. |
| Product Quality Concern | Any issues with goods or services produced by the Company. This would include outdated products, poor workmanship, etc. |
| Product Tampering | Any deliberate deviation from production SOPs with the intent to produce substandard quality or to cause product harm. |
| Release of Proprietary information | The conveying of information considered sensitive by the Company to another person, company, or entity by any person. Issues related to the buying or selling of a stock based on insider information should be classified as 'Insider Trading'. For more information, see the 'Insider Trading' definition. |
| Retaliation Against Whistleblowers | Adverse treatment of an individual in retaliation for their report of unethical activity in the workplace. The victim is required to have filed a concern/Report in order for them to be considered a 'whistle blower'.<br><br><u>Example:</u> A manager threatens, abuses or carries out other forms of harassment directly or indirectly against a person (including their family or friends), who has made an ethics violation report. |
| Safety Issues and Sanitation | Any condition which appears to be hazardous or unsanitary to the well-being of an employee, customer, facility, or general public. |
| Sexual Harassment | Unwelcome advances, request for sexual favours, and other verbal or physical conduct of a sexual nature may constitute sexual harassment. |

DRAFT

| Incident Report Type | Definition |
|---|---|
| Substance Abuse | The abuse of alcohol, or any illegal or any legal drug used in the workplace or being used while at work. |
| Theft or Misuse of Company Assets / Services | The taking or removal of any merchandise or property from the premises of the Company without authoritative permission and with the intent to permanently deprive the Company of the goods. |
| Theft of Time | Any act or omission, which causes an employee to be paid for, time not worked for the benefit of the Company. |
| Vendor / Supplier | When an Incident Reporter identifies themselves as a Vendor or Supplier. This classification is used regardless of the nature of the complaint. |
| Wage / Hour Issues | Any departure from existing labour laws or concerns over hours or wages.<br><br>Examples: Employees being asked or required to work overtime without the appropriate compensation. Employees not paid for the work they have performed. Employees being paid less than minimum wage. |
| Workplace Violence / Threats | Any act which causes physical injury to a person or any acts or statements which cause a person to believe that their physical well-being is in jeopardy. |
| Other Policy Issues / Breaches | Any issue with non-compliance with policies not covered in the other Incident Report types. |

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**Appendix II – Investigations Classification by Department**

If there is a risk that a Report may lead to litigation and/or there is a reasonable expectation of legal action outside of common HR matters resulting in termination, promptly confer with Internal Audit (Director or VP) which will confer with or direct you to confer with the Company's Legal team (SVP, General Counsel, Communications & Corporate Secretary) for further instruction including with respect to securing privilege and/or preserving documents.

With regard to the three tables included in this Appendix, please be advised of the following:

- **Examples:** These are not intended to be an exhaustive list but rather to provide context. Where Departments are unclear as to whether a Significant or Minor investigation is required, please contact Internal Audit (Director or VP).
- **Severity of Report Levels:**
  - **High:** Reports that have the potential to cause serious harm, involve legal or criminal implications, result in significant reputational damage, or lead to systemic failure. These issues require immediate and thorough investigation to mitigate risks and prevent severe consequences.
  - **Medium:** Reports that may have a moderate impact on operations, may involve localized issues, or indicate procedural non-compliance. While they do not pose an immediate threat, they still require timely attention to prevent escalation and ensure smooth functioning.
  - **Low:** Reports that have likely minimal or no impact, are easily correctable, and do not pose harm or risk beyond the immediate context. These issues can be addressed during routine processes without requiring urgent intervention.
- **Urgency of Investigation Levels:**
  - **Immediate:** Requires prompt action to prevent escalation or harm. Immediate planning is essential, and investigative actions should be taken with deliberate speed, depending on the availability of information and witnesses. Situations often involve potential threats to safety, security, or major operational disruptions. Addressing these issues quickly is crucial to mitigate risks and prevent further complications.
  - **Timely:** Issues should be addressed soon but are not considered emergencies. These situations may impact operations or procedures but do not pose an immediate threat. Timely responses ensure that problems are resolved before they escalate, maintaining smooth and efficient operations.
  - **Low:** These issues can be monitored or resolved during routine processes. They generally have limited effects and do not present notable risks outside of the specific situation. Addressing low urgency matters during regular operations helps maintain overall efficiency without requiring immediate intervention.

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**Level 1: Significant Investigation**

This table outlines the procedures, responsibilities, and key considerations for conducting **Significant** investigations across the Departments, highlighting the severity, urgency, and examples of Reports that warrant comprehensive inquiry within the organization. Many Significant Investigations will require cross-functional teams to support but the below chart highlights the initial and primary lead Department on the types of situations described below.

| | IA | HR | OHS | FSQA | AC |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Definition** | Investigation into Reports alleging violations of law, Company policy, procedures or best practices, that could result in **significant consequences** for individuals and/or the Company. | Investigation into Reports alleging **serious** HR matters that contradict HR policies associated with unfair and harmful treatment of employees, these generally are thought to have the **potential to result in termination** of an employee. | Investigation into Reports alleging circumstances whereby an undesired event has or may occur that has the potential to contribute to **serious injury, fatality, or significant damage** to Company assets. | Investigation into Reports alleging undesirable impact on product safety, quality, legality, or regulatory compliance that may pose an **immediate or widespread risk** to consumer health, brand integrity, or regulatory standing. | Investigation into Reports alleging management's failure to address animal welfare concerns, and Reports with **potential reputational risks from criminal findings or media exposure**. These are initially classified as significant but may be downgraded upon review. **Egregious Golden Rules** violations that involve severe, **intentional** animal abuse or neglect, may be criminal in nature. |
| **Examples** | • Fraud, embezzlement, or corruption resulting in material financial impact (>$5K) | • Harassment (e.g., sexual) or discrimination<br>• Theft of any kind, including time theft | • Critical, medical treatment, or lost time injuries<br>• Significant or major security incidents (e.g. unauthorized | • Food fraud or intentional product tampering, mislabeling or adulteration<br>• Product recalls or withdrawals | • Undercover third-party video showing an employee abusing an animal |

| | IA | HR | OHS | FSQA | AC |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | • Material theft of money, goods or time (>$5K)<br>• Retaliation against Whistleblowers<br>• Accounting or financial reporting errors or omissions<br>• Reports that may result in potential legal implications or reputational risk | • Workplace violence or threats | physical access to critical production areas)<br>• Property damage which is permanent in nature including building, or structure, or malfunctioning of equipment<br>• Reportable spills which meet the reportable limit threshold<br>• Environmental compliance issues requiring an action plan, such as environmental orders from a regulatory body pertaining to environmental effects<br>• Safety issues with potential for personal harm or material damage to brand reputation | • Consumer or customer complaints alleging illness, or foreign material in product<br>• Non-compliance of food safety or quality standards by Company or supplier resulting in product quality concern causing personal harm or material damage to brand reputation<br>• Significant regulatory risk (e.g. CFIA, FDA, Health Canada) | • Management failure to take corrective actions regarding animal welfare<br>• Animal abuse that warrants notifying authorities/pressing charges<br>• Deliberate neglect and abusive handling of birds<br>• Failure to euthanize or use of improper euthanasia method |
| **Severity** | High | High | High | High | High |
| **Urgency** | Immediate | Immediate | Immediate | Immediate | Immediate |

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**Level 2: Minor Investigation**

This table outlines the procedures, responsibilities, and key considerations for conducting a **Minor** investigation across the Departments, highlighting the severity, urgency, and examples of Reports that warrant inquiry within the organization. A **Minor** investigation may reveal egregious elements, prompting escalation to a **Significant** investigation.

| | IA | HR | OHS | FSQA | AC |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Definitions** | Investigation into Reports alleging a breach of policy, procedures, or best practices that **do not present significant** legal, financial, or reputational risk, but could lead to **moderate consequences** for individuals or the Company, if substantiated. | Investigation into Reports alleging **routine** HR matters that may contradict HR policies but would **not be considered a serious violation.** These generally are thought to have the potential to **result in disciplinary action but not termination** of an employee. | Investigation into Reports alleging circumstances whereby an undesired event has or may occur that has the potential to contribute to **non-serious injury or minor damage** to Company assets. | Investigation into Reports alleging undesirable impact on product safety, quality, legality, or regulatory compliance, that may result in a **limited or localized impact but does not pose an immediate or widespread risk** to consumer health, brand integrity, or regulatory standing. | Investigation into Reports of **Golden Rules incidents classified as serious or severe** but does **not meet the threshold for significant investigation**. |
| **Examples** | • Misuse of Company resources (e.g. using company assets such as a vehicle for personal use or a manager assigning staff to repair their manager's personal property)<br>• Fraud resulting in immaterial financial impact (<$5K)<br>• Repeated Reports (whether multiple occurrences for an | • Insubordination<br>• Insolent/uncooperative behaviour<br>• Reporting to work under the influence of a substance<br>• Health and safety violations (with engagement of OHS Department)<br>• Not meeting job expectations | • First aid incidents<br>• Near-miss/close call incidents<br>• Report only incidents<br>• Minor security incidents, (e.g. temporary failure of a non-critical security camera)<br>• Minor property damage incidents (causing temporary damage to materials, building, | • No possible harm to anyone, but possibly an impact to sales<br>• Consumer complaints involving quality concerns that may affect product acceptability but not safety (e.g. off-flavor, texture issues)<br>• Repeated minor deviations that indicate a | • Unintentionally negligent in providing water, food, or safe shelter based on normal site procedures<br>• Negligent in providing timely veterinary care or delaying euthanasia<br>• Handler with poor animal empathy or handling practices |

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| | IA | HR | OHS | FSQA | AC |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | individual or multiple occurrences of a similar nature) | • Working outside functional restrictions<br>• Culpable absenteeism<br>• Failure to follow SOPs | or structure, or malfunctioning of equipment to the site)<br>• Non-reportable spills | potential trend or systemic issue<br>• Supplier issues potentially affecting non-critical ingredients or packaging components | resulting in serious distress to livestock |
| **Severity** | Medium | Medium | Medium | Medium | Medium |
| **Urgency** | Timely | Timely | Timely | Timely | Timely |

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**Level 3: No Formal Investigation**

This table outlines the procedures, responsibilities, and key considerations where no investigation is required across the Departments.

| | IA | HR | OHS | FSQA | AC |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Definition** | Reports alleging a **very minor (e.g. low-risk or of an isolated nature)** breach of policy, procedures, or best practices that **do not present any significant or moderate risk**. | Reports alleging **very minor** HR matters that are **not considered serious** and there is **no expectation that disciplinary action** will result. | Reports alleging circumstances whereby an undesired event has or may occur where there is **no expectation of injury or damage** to Company assets. | Reports alleging circumstance whereby there is **no expectation** that product safety or quality has been compromised or that laws or regulations have been contravened. These issues will **not have an impact on consumers or the Company**. | Reports alleging **very minor (e.g. moderate Golden Rules)** incidents of inappropriate treatment of animals. |
| **Examples** | • Very minor misuse of Company resources such as stationery, office furniture, parking spaces or meeting rooms | • Personality clashes or communication style differences<br>• Not being selected for overtime<br>• Co-workers not being friendly or engaging<br>• Complaints about room temperature | • A light bulb burned out in a non-critical area, such as in an office or non-production area<br>• Minor spill of non-hazardous material (e.g. water or drink) on the cafeteria floor | • Low-risk consumer complaints or isolated quality deviations that do not affect food safety or legality (e.g. minor labeling concerns, packaging defects without food contact)<br>• Non-conformances that are contained and have no impact on released product | • Actions which result in minimal or no stress to livestock<br>• Infraction caused by inattention or carelessness<br>• Incomplete understanding of standard or lacking competency |

DRAFT

| | IA | HR | OHS | FSQA | AC |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Severity** | Low | Low to Medium | Low to Medium | Low to Medium | Low to Medium |
| **Urgency** | Low | Low | Low | Low | Low |

DRAFT

**Appendix III – Significant Investigation Report Template**

# Significant Investigation Report Template

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[Name of Investigation]

[Month and Year of Investigation]
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**Introduction / Background**

- Date the Report was received
- Indicate whether the Incident Reporter was anonymous
- How the Report was received (e.g. EthicsLine, direct report)
- Summary of the alleged Report

Example:

**On May 14, 2025**, **Maple Leaf Foods (MLF) Information Services (IS) directly alerted Internal Audit (IA) to a manager's (the "Manager") potentially inappropriate business activities.** The Manager's email correspondence with MLF Accounts Payable (AP) team revealed a request to establish a new vendor, Northbridge Consulting Group, which was flagged by IS due to a potentially fictitious business address, indicating a high likelihood of fraudulent activity.

**Allegation**

- Further detail of the alleged Report, such as:
  - What is the alleged Report?
  - How long has the issue persisted?
  - Who is involved in the allegation (names and titles of individuals)?
  - What Company policy, SOP, or best practice could the allegation breach?

Example:

- **Conflict of Interest**: **Since April 2025,** the **Manager may have been violating S. 3.8 of the MLF Code of Conduct (the "Code") by not disclosing a conflict of interest** related to a personal relationship with Northbridge Consulting Group, a company in which he or his family members have an ownership stake. Additionally, through his employment, **he established Northbridge Consulting Group as a vendor to MLF and awarded the Cold Storage Expansion Project to them**.

**Key Findings**

- Details regarding steps that the Investigator took to determine whether the allegation is substantiated
  - Company policies reviewed for potential breach
  - Details of interviews conducted
    - Date of interview(s)
    - Name and title of individual(s) interviewed
    - Details of interviews with key persons
  - Details of supporting documentation obtained (e.g. emails, messages, logs)

Example:

The following is a summary of IA's key findings that resulted from an **interview with the Manager and eight other MLF employees** as well as a **review of other evidence** such as emails, invoices, and other

DRAFT

relevant documents. For a complete list of employees interviewed, refer to *Appendix I – List of Employees Interviewed and Dates of these Interviews*.

- **Contrary to S. 3.8 Family and Friends of the Code**, the Manager **did not disclose his personal relationship** with Northbridge Consulting Group to his superior Karen D'Souza. The **Manager acknowledged** that engaging Northbridge Consulting Group, a company in which his family and friends have significant interest, constituted a conflict of interest and violation of the Code when acting in his capacity as a MLF manager.
- **Investigation into Northbridge Consulting Group's website**, www.northbridgecg.com, indicated that its content was AI generated, made claims to have completed $1 billion in projects across North America, lacked a phone number and had an alias mailing address that traced back to an apartment building. While the corporate address given by Northbridge Consulting Group to MLF was 1234 Kingsway Avenue, Toronto ON, the company's directors (owners), **Daniel Smith and Maria Keene, both identified** Northbridge Consulting Group's address on **corporate documents** to be 25 Oakridge Crescent, Brampton ON, which matched the address listed in the **Manager's MLF employee profile**.
- Northbridge Consulting Group's two directors are the Manager's close friend and spouse, and the company is registered to the Manager's home address, further reinforcing the personal connections that should have disqualified the Manager from involvement in vendor selection.
- The **Manager** used his position to favour the vendor by submitting vendor requests and expediting the purchase order for the Cold Storage Expansion Project.

**Conclusion**

- Clearly state whether the allegation is substantiated
  - Restate the details of the allegation and any breach of Company policy, SOP, or best practice detail and directly address these in the conclusion.

<u>Example:</u>

The allegation was **substantiated**.

- The **Manager failed to disclose a personal relationship with Northbridge Consulting Group's owners, violating S. 3.8 of the Code**, and exploited his employment position to establish Northbridge Consulting Group as a vendor to MLF and award them the Cold Storage Expansion Project. **Under the Code, this constitutes a conflict of interest, and the Manager is prohibited from participating in any decision-making related to such a vendor.**

**Actions Taken**

- Details of steps taken following the investigation to ensure a resolution is reached
  - Date steps were taken
  - Titles of individuals responsible to complete resolution steps

DRAFT

Example:

- **May 15, 2025**: HR was contacted, the **Manager was placed on administrative leave pending the outcome of the investigation** and on **May 16, 2025**, the **Manager was terminated**.
- **May 15, 2025**: IA requested that the **MLF Senior Manager, AP ("Senior Manager AP") monitor the Northbridge Consulting Group account**, which had net 90 payment terms, and notify IA of any changes in payment status.

**Preventative Measures**

- How will MLF ensure the incident(s) leading to this Report will not reoccur?

Example:

IA has noted that there are improvements that could be considered for incorporation into MLF's vendor vetting process that would help prevent a Report such as this in the future. **IA intends to include a specific engagement in our future audit plan to identify opportunities to tighten this process**.

**Appendix I**

- List of names and titles of individuals interviewed as well as dates of interviews conducted.

DRAFT

**Appendix IV – Minor Investigation Report Template**

# Minor Investigation Report Template

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[Name of Investigation]

[Month and Year of Investigation]
Privileged & Confidential – Not for Distribution

**Introduction / Background**

- Date the Report was received
- Indicate whether the Incident Reporter was anonymous
- How the Report was received and (e.g. EthicsLine, direct report)
- Summary of the alleged Report

Example:

**On June 3, 2025**, an **anonymous employee** (the "Employee") **contacted EthicsLine alleging unauthorized use of company-provided housing at the Willow Creek Property in Northfield, ON.**

**Allegation**

- Further details of the alleged Report, such as:
  - What is the alleged Report?
  - How long has the issue persisted?
  - Who is involved in the allegation (names and titles of individuals)?
  - What Company policy, SOP, or best practice could the allegation breach?

Example:

The **Animal Care Technician ("the Technician") invited a non-employee to reside in a separate bedroom in the Willow Creek Property without formal approval, breaching the lease agreement**. The non-employee has reportedly been living in the company-owned residence **since May 30, 2025**, without paying rent. It was further alleged that the **Willow Creek Property Manager ("the Property Manager") was aware of and permitted this arrangement**, which made other residents in the house feel pressured to accept the non-employee's presence.

**Key Findings**

- Details regarding steps that the Investigator took to determine whether the allegation is substantiated
  - Company policies reviewed for potential breach
  - Details of interviews conducted
    - Date of interview(s)
    - Name / title of individual(s) interviewed
    - Details of discussions had
  - Details of supporting documentation obtained (e.g. emails, messages, logs)

Example:

The following is a summary of key findings that resulted from **HR's interview with the Technician and the Property Manager** as well as a **review of the lease agreement**.

- **On June 5, 2025**, **IA contacted HR** to inquire about the process for employees residing in company-owned residences and to communicate the details of the allegation. **HR indicated they would speak**

DRAFT

**with the Manager and the Technician involved** in the alleged unauthorized activity, subsequently reporting any findings back to IA.

- **HR reviewed the lease agreement** and confirmed that by having a friend, a non-employee, stay at the Willow Creek Property without required approval, the **Technician breached the terms of their lease agreement, which stipulates that only family members by marriage, birth, or adoption may reside at the Willow Creek Property**.
- Although the Technician had verbal approval from the Property Manager, the Property Manager neglected to obtain the required authorization from HR before allowing the Technician's friend to move in.
- The Technician and Property Manager did not intend to deceive or bypass the process; however, the Property Manager inadvertently failed to recall the requirement to request HR approval. HR was unaware of, and did not approve, the non-employee's stay.
- The non-employee was not authorized to reside at the Willow Creek Property, had no lease agreement, and did not pay rent.
- It is unknown if the Willow Creek Property residents felt pressured to accept the non-employee, as the Property Manager did not consult them, and no concerns were reported.

**Conclusion**

- Clearly state whether the allegation is substantiated
    - Restate the allegation and any breach of Company policy, SOP, or best practice in detail.

<u>Example:</u>

The allegation is **substantiated**.

- The investigation **confirmed that a non-employee was living in the Willow Creek Property without proper approval, breaking the lease agreement rules**. Although the Technician received verbal consent from the Property Manager, it did not go through the required approval from HR. It appears that neither the Technician nor the Property Manager intended to deceive or bypass the process; they simply failed to recall that HR approval was a requirement. If HR had been informed before the friend moved in, they would have denied the request immediately.
- The investigation revealed that the Property Manager lacked awareness of the tenant approval process. Specifically, the Property Manager was not aware of the requirement to have HR approve the Technician's friend living at the Willow Creek Property.

**Actions Taken**

- Details of steps taken following the investigation to ensure a resolution is reached
    - Date steps were taken
    - Titles of individuals responsible to complete resolution steps

DRAFT

Example:

- **June 6, 2025: HR informed the Technician that the appropriate approval process had not been followed**. The Technician was informed that the **non-employee whom they invited to reside at the Willow Creek Property is required to vacate the property within one week**.

**Preventative Measures**

- How will MLF ensure the incident(s) leading to this Report will not reoccur?

Example:

- **June 7, 2025: HR reminded Property Managers that only tenants with valid rental lease agreements meeting all criteria can reside on company properties. All occupants must be approved by both the Property Manager and HR.**

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